a solution provider, it is important to check if the firm has consistently provided technical support services and delivered application level uptime."

Payment model

Mr Chandilya, shares, "There are two hosting models. One is to pay per allocation, and the second is to pay based on consumption. The first option means paying for whatever is allocated to you, irrespective of whether you use it or not. In the pay for what is consumed model, you pay for whatever you use. An example of the first model is the reality market. If you lease some property, you have to pay for it irrespective of whether you used it or not. An example of paying for what you consume is electricity bills, when you pay for only the amount of power that you use. In our industry, there are providers who invoice for allocation like co-location services and cloud infrastructure. While selecting a provider, it is very important that you pay only for resources you use, like in a utility model."

Executive dashboard

This is the fourth important aspect to consider when choosing a service provider. Says Mr Chandilya, "It is really important to monitor your services availability. Ultimately, the goal of hosting is to get better application uptime to serve end customers consistently and generate revenue. So it becomes vital to monitor service uptime. How do you know that you are achieving the ultimate goal of hosting? To get this information, it is very important to get an executive dashboard for monitoring, from the service provider. Every role in an organisation requires a different level of monitoring. Some hosting providers offer a monitoring interface. If the firm permits monitoring of hardware parameters like RAM, CPU, disk and bandwidth usage, this actually helps IT administrators more than it helps CIOs or CTOs, who require end-to-end monitoring of application availability. The latter need a dashboard to monitor if applications are working fine and delivering what is expected. So an executive dashboard is an important feature that customers should ask for."

Service level agreements (SLAs) and penalties are yet another vital criteria. While choosing any provider, customers should check if they are ready to provide SLAs to underscore their commitments and if they are ready to accept penalties, if the level of service committed to is not delivered. There are multiple factors in an SLA. Sometimes, even though SLAs are in place, the clauses in them are not relevant to the expected service. As solution providers, hosting companies should also help customers to develop the right SLA and deliver based on its terms. For customers, there should be mechanisms to monitor and audit whether services are being provided as promised in an SLA.

Data segregation and recovery

Mitesh Agarwal, VP – sales consulting and CTO, Oracle India, shares, "In the case of public cloud environments, it is critical to make sure hosting providers can guarantee complete data segregation for secure multi-tenancy. Enterprises must also make sure their hosting provider has the ability to do a complete restoration in the event of a disaster."

A few companies that offer IaaS products

Oracle Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) Private Cloud: Oracle's IaaS Private Cloud delivers Oracle Engineered Systems hardware and support for a monthly fee, with no upfront capital expenditure. It combines the security and control of on-premise systems with unique features of cloud computing, including 'capacity on demand', which enables businesses to access and pay for peak CPU capacity only when needed.

ESDS' eNlight Managed Cloud: Since every business is unique in its own way, its cloud solution also needs to be unique. Hence, the firm offers specially engineered intelligent cloud computing architecture for businesses. ESDS' eNlight claims to give its users the right cloud infrastructure, perfectly pooled resources and dependable technical support to run business enterprises dynamically.

Netmagic Solutions: Netmagic Solutions says it has the depth and breadth of expertise to professionally manage critical IT infrastructure. With its IaaS products, India based enterprises can enjoy immense financial benefits such as cost reductions of between 20-30 per cent of IT operations, decoupling IT costs from people but linking them directly to infrastructure, as well as bringing about some predictability to IT costs.

END

Note: Details regarding some of the products mentioned in this article have been taken from the Internet.

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